

S02-03 - Bramble Union Ambush

Player read-aloud

Bramblefolk burst from the undergrowth, blades drawn. Their eyes keep flicking toward the carriage. They are here for the cargo.

Scene summary

Bramble Union reclaimers attack the carriage to seize the cargo.

Visible choices

- Fight to kill
- Fight to subdue
- Protect the crate
- Negotiate under pressure

Player questions

- What detail in Bramble Union Ambush tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?
- What detail on a reclaimer's gear makes them look like a craftsperson from a hidden community rather than a disposable bandit?

GM notes

- Offer ways to incapacitate, scare off, capture, or negotiate if players push for it.
- Keep player-facing information actionable. Reveal systemic truth through objects, reactions, and consequences before naming it.
- The Bramble Union ambush now points back to hidden villages, stoneweave armor, and thorns used as shelter from surveillance.
- Manufactured-threat lens: seed the contradiction, do not explain it. The surface goal stays simple and heroic.
- [REFLAVOR/GUARANTEED] The reclaimers target the cargo and manifest, not purses, and avoid killing when possible.
- [REFLAVOR/GUARANTEED] Their gear includes salvaged, repainted Grail/Kazrak kit: ex-workers, not feral bandits. (Knowledge Medium 15 to name the issue)
- [ADD/EARNED] "That stone belongs in the ground." "You do not know what you are carrying."

Checks and rolls

- Agility or Strength Hold the carriage line. Standard Prevent the Keystone from being seized. 15 Cleanly resolve: Hold the carriage line. Add a concrete boon, extra clue, or improved position. Success, plus the player names one helpful detail or asks one follow-up question. Success, but the GM exposes a cost, ticks a countdown, or

reveals a new pressure tied to Bramble Union Ambush. The full goal slips, but the party still learns a useful truth or avoids the worst consequence. The GM makes a hard move that follows from the fiction and leaves the next choice visible. Spend Fear to close the ambush net, threaten the Keystone route, or force a choice between cargo and mercy. On mixed or sliding results, reveal information in layers: visible fact, actionable clue, then systemic truth.

- Presence Force a pause for negotiation. Hard in combat Learn one displacement truth.
- 20 Cleanly resolve: Force a pause for negotiation. Add a concrete boon, extra clue, or improved position. Success, plus the player names one helpful detail or asks one follow-up question. Success, but the GM exposes a cost, ticks a countdown, or reveals a new pressure tied to Bramble Union Ambush. The full goal slips, but the party still learns a useful truth or avoids the worst consequence. The GM makes a hard move that follows from the fiction and leaves the next choice visible. Spend Fear to close the ambush net, threaten the Keystone route, or force a choice between cargo and mercy. On mixed or sliding results, reveal information in layers: visible fact, actionable clue, then systemic truth.

Clues

- Route sketch Someone leaked the route. Corporate logistics exposed Hush by treating risk as overhead. The Claimrunner knows the cargo route too well.
- Guaranteed seed The reclaimers target the cargo and manifest, not purses, and avoid killing when possible. The reclaimers target the cargo and manifest, not purses, and avoid killing when possible.
- Guaranteed seed Their gear includes salvaged, repainted Grail/Kazrak kit: ex-workers, not feral bandits. Their gear includes salvaged, repainted Grail/Kazrak kit: ex-workers, not feral bandits. Knowledge Medium 15 to name the issue
- Earned seed Available if players investigate, show mercy, or ask the right question. "That stone belongs in the ground." "You do not know what you are carrying."

Loot

- Use Bramble Union Ambushers and Claimrunner loot tables
- Bramble Union Stoneweave: A garment of thousands of tiny polished stones moves like cloth and turns thorns like armor. Every fitted piece looks cut by hands that loved the work.
- Vial of Briarpowder: A small stoppered vial holds fine grey-green thorn powder that seems to drink the light. A blade edge near it looks sharper and hungrier.
- Bramble Ward-Scrap Charm Cluster: A knot of blue ward shards, twine, and tiny salvage tags clacks softly at a Bramblefolk belt. It looks illegal only because it looks useful.
- Claimrunner Serrated Blade: A short serrated blade shows careful filing along the back edge and a handle wrapped in road cord. It is ugly in the practical way of a tool that has never had a decorative day.

Mechanics

- Plot So Far: The party is in Act Two pressure: Bramble Union reclaimers attack the

carriage to seize the cargo.

- Mechanics In Play: Use Daggerheart Duality Dice as baseline. Use the listed Difficulty and outcome options when a roll matters. Keep trivial actions no-roll; roll only when uncertainty, cost, or danger is interesting.
- Roll Cards: s02-03-talk-down-the-claimrunner S02-03 Talk down the claimrunner Talk down the claimrunner Presence Knowledge Presence Knowledge 15 Presence meets fear; Knowledge names the road claim. Violence becomes the only language if nobody offers another one. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that follows from the fiction. Violence becomes the only language if nobody offers...
- Gm Fear Spends: Close the ambush net or put a PC between cargo and a frightened reclamer. Reveal a personal effect that makes victory emotionally complicated.
- Conditions Hazards: Restrained Hidden
- Search Loot Clues: Bramble ambushers: route map, ward-stone scraps, Firstmoss, personal keepsakes; do not make bodies treasure chests.
- No Roll Guidance: Do not call for a roll when the players have time, a clear method, and no meaningful pressure.
- Escalation: Escalate by making cost visible: time, noise, trust, ward instability, or someone vulnerable in danger.
- Deescalation: De-escalate through respect, care, honest testimony, useful evidence, or a concrete concession.
- Tv Mechanics Caption: Public cue: Bramble Union Ambush asks what the party does, what it costs, and who is protected.
- Trait Variety Note: Primary traits in this scene: Agility, Finesse, Instinct, Knowledge, Presence, Strength. If rolls drift toward Instinct/Presence, ask whether Agility, Strength, Finesse, or Knowledge better describes the action.
- Class Community Ancestry Reveals: Loreborne: spots older legal, heraldic, or ward-craft language under the branding. Underborne: notices service doors, hidden routes, and who built the thing nobody credits. Highborne: reads etiquette, class panic, and reputational risk. Ridgeborne: notices stonework, weight, pressure, and structural weakness. Wildborne: reads the land, animals, and local ecological stress. Elf/Ribbet/Human/Giant/Katari: invite one sensory or social detail from the player's heritage. Sorcerer/Rogue/Warrior/Guardian/Ranger: give each class one table-facing way to shine without changing the plot.

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